



THESE ARE ATYPICAL times. The once-in-a-century Black Swan event of 2021 and 2022—we're not talking Covid-19 necessarily; we're talking lockdowns—forced governments, companies, schools, colleges, you, me, everybody, everywhere in the world, to go digital. As industry after industry sank to their knees in the face of the lockdowns, corporations frantically upped the pace of digitalisation, unwilling to be caught napping anymore in any lockdown-like scenario, or any other unforeseen-event scenario.

Yet, today it is the tech sector that is handing its employees the most pink slips in a layoff maelstrom.

Flip the coin. Employees are also merily hopping jobs. I can't buy an iPhone with this salary, I'm leaving. I don't like my boss, I'm leaving. This industry has no future, I'm leaving. I'm too good for you, you're not able to use my skills properly, I'm leaving. I'm falling behind, not learning anything new, I'm leaving.

All this, despite mass layoffs in some sectors, global recessionary fears, and inflationary pressures having taken root by mid-2022. Data from HR consulting firm Aon shows India Inc.'s voluntary attrition (as in, you decide to quit) rising to 17.5 per cent at the end of 2022, compared to 15.7 per cent in 2021. That difference is rather significant. In 2021, skyrocketing salaries, exorbitant joining bonuses and multiple job offers had become the norm in the Indian IT sector because of the digitalisation boom across industries. Yet, even in early 2023, it continues to be an

TALENT WATCH



Global recessionary fears are rocking export-oriented sectors such as IT/ITeS. But, India's bright prospects are making domestic-dependent sectors bullish



Despite worrying signs visible in global markets, hiring activity in December was up more than 4 per cent compared to a year ago. The Naukri JobSpeak Index rose to 2,890 in December 2022, from 2,770 a year ago



A sector-wise analysis by Naukri comparing December 2022 numbers with the average of the first half (January-June) reveals a mixed trend



The mix shifted in the second half of 2022, with domestic economy-driven sectors recording stronger growth



December 2022 numbers when compared to the average of H12022 showed a robust 51 per cent growth in hiring activity in the insurance sector; 33 per cent in the oil sector; 24 per cent in banking; 21 per cent in real estate; and 12 per cent in the auto sector



However, IT & BPO sectors linked to global markets declined by 19 per cent and 9 per cent, respectively, during this period

THE LONG WAIT

THE INDIAN TECH SECTOR HAS BEEN DELAYING ON-BOARDING OF FRESHERS

Company	Status
TCS	Delay in on-boarding by up to 6-8 months; delay in deployment of offer letters
Infosys	Delay of up to 10-12 months, along with delay in deployment of offer letters
Wipro	Delay in on-boarding by more than 12 months; company offered on-boarding if candidates agreed to salary cuts of around 50 per cent
Tech Mahindra	Delay in on-boarding by up to 12 months; several candidates say offer letters were revoked by the company
Mphasis	Delay in on-boarding by more than 12 months

SOURCE INDUSTRY